Quality assessment of evidence on exposure to air pollutants and incidence of pulmonary tuberculosis

Quality assessment of evidence on incidence of pulmonary tuberculosis						Summary of findings	
						Outcome/Total Participants	
Studies (Participants)*	**Limitation**[1]	**Inconsistency**[2]	**Indirectness**[3]	**Imprecision**[4]	**Publication bias**[5]	**Pooled Risk ratio (95% CI)**	**Overall Quality**
$PM_{2.5}$							
7 (63391)	Some limitations	Some inconsistency	No indirectness	No imprecision	Undetected	1.13 (1.06 – 1.20)	⊕⊕OO Low
PM_{10}							
10 (253788)	Some limitations	Some inconsistency	No indirectness	No imprecision	Undetected	1.05 (1.02 – 1.05)	⊕⊕OO Low
CO							
6 (63595)	Some limitations	Some inconsistency	No indirectness	Some imprecision	Undetected	1.01 (0.997 – 1.02)	⊕⊕OO Low
NO_2							
9 (128126)	Some limitations	Some inconsistency	No indirectness	No imprecision	Undetected	1.08 (1.03 – 1.13)	⊕⊕OO Low
SO_2							
10 (247988)	Some limitations	Some inconsistency	No indirectness	No imprecision	Undetected	1.06 (1.04 – 1.09)	⊕⊕OO Low
O_3							
6 (63595)	Some limitations	Some inconsistency	No indirectness	Some imprecision	Undetected	1.00 (0.99 – 1.02)	⊕⊕OO Low

(Participants)* - minimum number of participants as some studies did not report number of participants.

[7]Most studies reported limitations that could affect the generalizability of their findings.

[2]Despite similar measures of effect across the studies, there were significant heterogeneity and variability (I^2) across the studies.

[3]All patients and interventions studied were patients and interventions of interest.

[4]No imprecision except for CO and O_3 where there is some imprecision with the confidence intervals.

[5]No statistical evidence of publication bias